

Kivi Application: Product UI/UX Design

Product Vision

What Kivi should mean in a person's life

Kivi should be a tool for natural self-expression, not bound by the restrictions of having to use one language for communication. Most voice-to-text tools are not adapted for multilingual communication - they rely on predictable input in one language to transcribe it into the same script. While this improves productivity in one language, most people in India switch between languages by nature of growing up around multiple languages.

Using Kivi means that the natural tendency to switch languages need not be suppressed. An office worker could start off in Tamil, include technical terms in English and add in some Hindi for emphasis - the essence of all the statements are captured and output in a coherent fashion for others to understand. Thus, Kivi becomes an essential tool of self-expression and free thinking for its users.

Whom it should belong to

Kivi, being a primarily Indic language transcriber, should belong to people who grew up in culturally diverse environments. For these users, switching languages, codes and slangs were natural while conversing with friends, family and neighbours.

While other products are positioned as productivity tools for a global audience, Kivi hones in on the fact that it enables free self-expression for people used to thinking in more than one language.

Where it creates value that other products do not

Upon analysing other prominent competitors in the market such as Wisper Flow , Willow, Superwhisper, Aqua, almost all of them converge upon the same set of functions. These include features present in Kivi, such as smarter instruction-vs-text detection, style personalization, cross-app functionality and higher accuracy.

Kivi and other tools have comparable performances on these features, with apps continuously beating each other on performance metrics. The unique feature that puts Kivi on top is its extremely high accuracy with multilingual input involving Indian languages. Prioritising depth over breadth in language transcription means that Kivi is extremely specialised in Indian languages and is thus able to handle input when multiple languages are used, which is often the exact speaking style for most Indians in social settings.

Why someone would choose to keep it

With Kivi being effective at transcribing various Indian languages, it also better understands the original essence of phrases in these languages. With features like Dictionary and Shortcuts allowing the user to keep some catchphrases at hand, it allows the user much more freedom in employing multiple languages while speaking, with the nuances being captured across various languages. While other voice-to-text tools also offer personalisation, Kivi's expertise at Indian languages allows for catchphrases, slangs and sign-offs in multiple Indian languages. Switching to another tool means leaving behind an extensive library of encoded phrases as well as opting for sub-optimal

translations in Indian languages - the cost of which is too high for users to switch, thus cementing Kivi as their preferred tool.

What it must refuse to become

The positioning of Kivi as a tool of expression for people in multilingual spaces means that it can no longer brand itself as most other transcribers too - that is, as a productivity app that makes texting faster and more accurate. Productivity has a global appeal, which is certainly a tradeoff with the current positioning. However, productivity is measured by metrics that companies regularly surpass each other on, and therefore is not a clear differentiator. Kivi's new position as a tool for self-expression means that it must never chase productivity metrics for standing out, since it operates in a competitive market where new benchmarks are broken regularly. From a product design perspective, this also means that excessive cleanup should not be encoded into the transcription, ensuring that there is minimal language boundary drift.

